Mini Beef Wellingtons



Ingredients

Rough puff pastry

150g plain flour

150g unsalted butter, *cold, cut into small cubes*

75ml cold water (approximately)

½ tsp salt

1 tsp lemon juice, *white vinegar*

Beef and mushroom filling

200–240g beef fillet, *cut into 4 equal pieces*

150g mushrooms, *finely chopped*

1 small shallot, *finely chopped*

1 garlic clove, *minced*

1 tbsp butter

1 tsp fresh thyme leaves

1 tsp Dijon mustard

Salt and black pepper

1 tbsp olive oil

Egg wash

1 egg

1 tsp water

Preparation Steps

Rough puff pastry

1. Combine flour and salt in a mixing bowl.

2. Add the cold butter cubes. Toss through the flour, keeping the butter pieces relatively large and visible. Do not rub them in.

3. Mix the cold water with the lemon juice or vinegar. Gradually add to the flour mixture, bringing everything together into a rough dough. Add a little more water if necessary.

4. Turn onto a lightly floured surface and gently shape into a rectangle.

5. Roll into a long rectangle approximately three times as long as it is wide.

6. Fold the top third down and the bottom third up over it, like folding a letter.

7. Rotate the pastry 90 degrees and roll out again.

8. Repeat the folding process three more times, chilling for 20 minutes if the butter starts getting soft.

9. Wrap and refrigerate for at least 30 minutes before using.

Mushroom duxelles

10. Finely chop the mushrooms, shallot and garlic. A food processor can make this easier, but don't turn them into a puree.

11. Melt the butter in a frying pan over medium heat.

12. Add the shallot and cook for 2 minutes.

13. Add mushrooms, garlic and thyme.

14. Cook for approximately 10–15 minutes, stirring regularly, until all moisture has evaporated and the mixture is quite dry.

15. Season with salt and pepper.

16. Allow to cool completely.

Beef

17. Pat the beef dry with paper towels.

18. Season generously with salt and pepper.

19. Heat olive oil in a frying pan until very hot.

20. Sear the beef pieces on all sides, approximately 30–45 seconds per side. You only want to brown the outside.

21. Remove and allow to cool completely.

22. Brush each piece with Dijon mustard.

Assembly and cooking

23. Preheat oven to 200°C conventional or 180°C fan.

24. Roll the pastry to approximately 3mm thick.

25. Cut four squares large enough to wrap each piece of beef.

26. Place a thin layer of mushroom mixture in the centre of each square.

27. Place a piece of beef on top.

28. Fold the pastry around the beef, sealing the edges underneath. Trim away excess pastry.

29. Place seam-side down on a lined baking tray.

30. Brush with egg wash.

31. Refrigerate for 15–20 minutes to firm up the pastry.

32. Brush with a second layer of egg wash if desired.

33. Bake for approximately 15–20 minutes until golden and puffed. Use a meat thermometer to check the beef is cooked to your preferred doneness.

34. Rest for 5 minutes before serving.